BSU-IACUC User Manual

For researchers: applying for protocol review and animal research clearance

About this manual

The BSU-IACUC portal is where you submit a research protocol for review by CCARD, follow its progress, pay the clearance fee, and download your animal research clearance. This manual walks you through each stage in order. You can also open the interactive User Guide from the footer or the account menu, and the Page guide button on each page.

1. Create and manage your account

Register

1. Press **Register** in the header.
2. Fill in your username, first and last name, email, phone number, school, sex, researcher type, and password. The form lists the password requirements.
3. Submit the form. Your username and email must not already be in use.
4. Open the verification link sent to your email. If it is invalid or expired, request a new one from your account page. You can request another link after a short wait.

Sign in

Use your username or email with your password. After repeated failed attempts, sign-in is locked for 15 minutes. Use the forgot password link on the sign-in page if you cannot remember your password.

My Profile

Open the account menu and choose **My Profile** to update your details, view your IACUC training certificate and its verification status, upload a new certificate if it is rejected, turn email notifications on or off, or delete your account.

> Your account is deactivated automatically after your clearance expires and you have no pending protocols. You can reactivate it at any time by signing in again.

2. Finding your way around

- **Home**: about IACUC, how to apply, and frequently asked questions.
- **My Protocols**: every protocol you have submitted, with its status and actions.
- **Announcements**: news from the CCARD office and partner pages.
- **Contact Us**: details of CCARD and related offices.
- **Notification bell**: shows a badge when there is something new.
- **Theme**: switch between Light, Dark, and Auto.
- **Account menu**: My Profile, User Guide, and Log Out.

3. Apply for protocol review

Press **New Application** on My Protocols. The application has six steps, shown as dots at the top of the page. Finished steps show a check mark.

Step	What you do
1. Requirements	Read what you need and how the process works. First-time submitters need an IACUC training certificate. It is a one-time requirement: CCARD verifies it once, and it is reused for later applications.
2. Terms	Read and agree to the terms of use and the privacy policy by ticking both boxes.
3. Documents	Attach your IACUC training certificate (PDF, JPG, or PNG, max 10 MB). If you already submitted one, this is noted.
4. Download form	Download the official IACUC protocol form (Word .DOCX) and complete it.
5. Upload and submit	Part 1: print, sign, and scan the completed form, then upload it (PDF, DOC, or DOCX, max 10 MB). Part 2: enter the protocol title, animal type, animal count, research adviser, and veterinarian exactly as written on your form. Press **Submit protocol**.
6. Done	Your protocol is submitted and appears in My Protocols as Under Review.

> Only the Principal Investigator (PI) may submit an IACUC protocol. Multiple submissions of the same protocol will be rejected, and each protocol needs a title that no other protocol uses.

Word files are converted to PDF for submission. Review the converted file, since conversion can shift the layout slightly.

Your progress is saved as you go. Press **Home** on the application page to leave, and resume the application from My Protocols later.

4. Training certificate verification

CCARD verifies your IACUC training certificate once, after your first submission. You do not need to upload it again for later protocols.

Certificate status	What it means and what to do
Pending	CCARD is checking your certificate. A banner on My Protocols reminds you. Until it is verified, you cannot submit new protocols, and your protocols cannot be marked Reviewed.
Verified	No action needed. You are notified, and the certificate is not asked for again.
Rejected	The reviewer found a problem and left a note, which you also receive by notification and email. Open **My Profile**, read the note, and press **Upload new**.

To resubmit a rejected certificate, upload a new file (PDF, JPG, or PNG, max 10 MB) from My Profile and confirm. The status returns to Pending and CCARD is notified. Earlier files and notes are kept in your history.

5. Track your protocol

Each protocol card in My Protocols shows a status icon, the title, and the submission date. Use the status filters at the top to narrow the list, and the sort menu to order it. Press the question mark at the end of the status bar for a quick reminder of what each status means.

Status	What it means and what to do
Under Review	No action needed. CCARD is reviewing your protocol and you are notified of every feedback given. It cannot move to Reviewed until your training certificate is verified.
Needs Revision	The reviewer found an issue and sent your protocol back. Revise it following the comments and re-submit your file.
Reviewed	The reviewer has finished the assessment. View the payment options to process your animal research clearance. After payment verification, wait for your protocol to be endorsed to DA-CARFU.
Endorsed	No action needed. Your protocol has been endorsed to the Department of Agriculture-Cordillera Administrative Region Field Unit (DA-CARFU). Wait while the Bureau of Animal Industry (BAI) Central Office processes your clearance.
Approved	Your protocol is approved. Download your animal research clearance and visit the BSU-CCARD office to claim the embossed hard copy.

Open shows the protocol and its files. **Show History** lists every submission round, including your revisions.

6. If your protocol needs revision

1. Open the protocol marked Needs Revision and press **Review Comments & Re-submit**.
2. Read the reviewer's comments, then revise your protocol file.
3. Upload the revised file (PDF, DOC, or DOCX, max 10 MB). The protocol goes back to Under Review.

7. Pay the clearance fee

When a protocol is Reviewed, press **View Payment Options**. The Bureau of Animal Industry processes animal research clearances for a fee of Php 100.00.

- Researchers from Benguet State University pay in person at the BSU-CCARD office, then tick the confirmation box.
- Researchers from other schools choose between paying in person at CCARD or paying online. For online payment, contact the CCARD Director through the Contact Us page, then upload your proof of payment (PDF, JPG, or PNG, max 10 MB).

Administrative staff verify your payment. If it is rejected, you are notified with the reason and can press **Resubmit Proof**.

8. After approval

- Download your animal research clearance from the protocol card, and visit the BSU-CCARD office to claim the embossed hard copy.
- **Submit Amendment**: once the clearance is released, open the protocol and submit an updated file with a short note explaining what changed (up to 1000 characters). CCARD is notified.
- **Rename** and **Request Deletion** are also on the protocol page when available. A deletion request needs a reason and is sent to administrative staff for a decision.

Troubleshooting

Problem	What to try
Verification link does not work	Request a new link from your account page and wait a moment between requests.
Cannot sign in	Check your username or email and password. After repeated failures, wait 15 minutes before trying again.
Upload is rejected	Check the file type and keep it under 10 MB. Protocol files accept PDF, DOC, or DOCX. Certificates and payment proofs accept PDF, JPG, or PNG.
Cannot submit a new protocol	Your training certificate must be verified first. Open My Profile to see its status, and upload a new one if it was rejected.
Title already exists	Choose a different protocol title.

For anything else, use the Contact Us page to reach CCARD.